CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO DIGITAL ACADEMY | CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

# Social Media Marketing Course Handbook

"Grow brands and businesses on the platforms people live on."



Brand Community & Social Strategy Track | 8 Weeks | All Levels 28-Page Illustrated Edition

Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame | chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com

# Course Foreword



Billions of people spend hours a day on social media, and every business wants their attention. Social media marketing, growing and engaging an audience to build a brand and drive sales, is a skill in massive demand, whether you freelance for clients, run your own venture, or get hired in-house.

It is more than posting randomly and hoping. It is strategy: knowing your audience, planning content, creating value, engaging genuinely, and measuring results. This book teaches that professional approach, so you get real outcomes, not just likes.

## THE PRACTITIONER PROMISE

You will learn to choose platforms, plan a content strategy, create engaging posts, grow on Instagram, Facebook, TikTok and YouTube, read your analytics, and run paid ads.

Practice on a real account, your own or a business you help. Social media is learned by creating, posting and studying what actually happens.

Published by CHRISCO Digital Academy under CHRISCO Youth Aflame (*CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches*), this expanded 28-page illustrated handbook unpacks every module in spacious detail with visual diagrams, real East African case studies, and step-by-step labs. Reach our mentorship desk anytime at chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.



# Key Learning Outcomes

## 01

Social media platforms overview: Each platform has its own audience and style.

## 02

Creating engaging content: Hook, value, and a clear reason to engage.

## 03

TikTok and YouTube basics: TikTok: authentic short video, huge discovery.

## 04

Paid advertising basics: A campaign is a focused push toward one goal.

Across 8 Weeks of structured practice, each of the 8 modules is given a dedicated two-page spread: first unpacking the concept visually, then walking through a real field scenario and hands-on lab.

By Module 08, you will have built and verified a complete community growth calendar ready to serve employers, clients, ministries, and communities with excellence.

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# 01
# Foundations & Core Mindset

Module 01: Social media platforms overview | Module 02: Content strategy and planning

MODULE 01 · PART 1

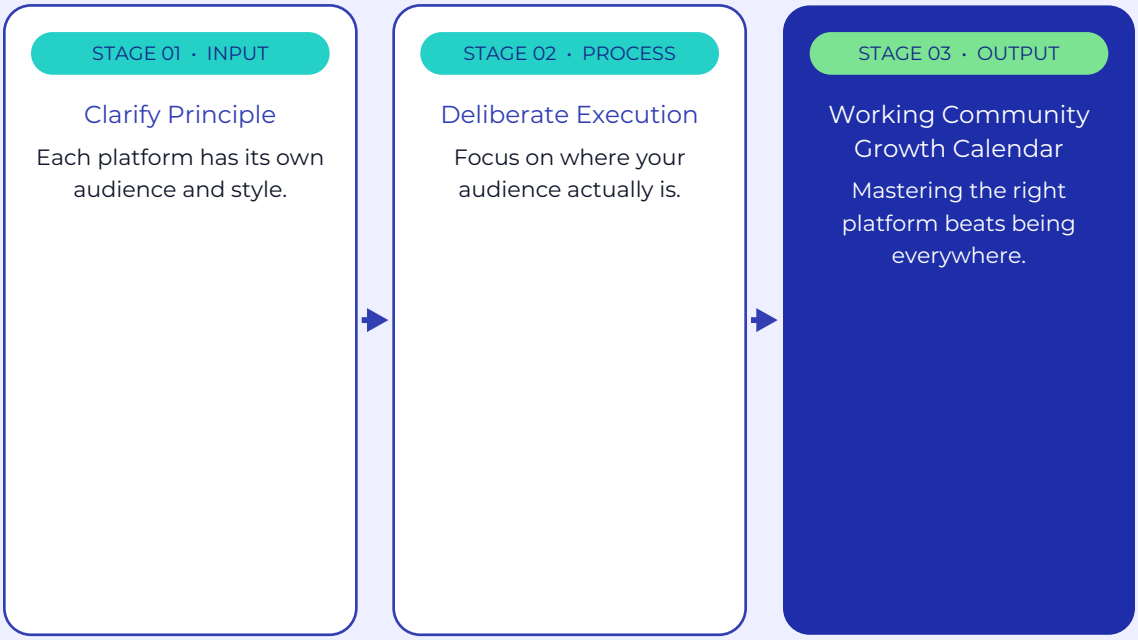
# 1.1 Social media platforms overview

Each platform has its own audience, culture and content style, and you should meet people where they are rather than trying to be everywhere. Instagram is visual and lifestyle-driven; Facebook has broad reach and strong communities/groups; TikTok favours short, authentic, entertaining video; YouTube is for longer video and search; LinkedIn is professional. Knowing these differences shapes your whole strategy.

Rather than spreading thin, choose the one or two platforms where your target audience actually spends time and where your content type fits. A B2B service belongs on LinkedIn; a youth fashion brand thrives on Instagram and TikTok. Mastering the right platform beats being mediocre on all of them, focus is a strategy, not a limitation.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *social media platforms overview* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real community growth calendar. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that each platform has its own audience and style., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 01: SOCIAL MEDIA PLATFORMS OVERVIEW





MODULE 01 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A local restaurant wasted effort on LinkedIn before realising its customers were on Instagram and Facebook. Refocusing there, appetising photos and local community posts, finally brought real bookings. Right platform, right result.

## How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Social Media Marketing workbook.

### HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 01

Your Practical Task: For a business you know, identify the one or two platforms where its target customers actually spend time, and why those fit best.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

## Module 01 Key Takeaways

01

Each platform has its own audience and style.

02

Focus on where your audience actually is.

03

Mastering the right platform beats being everywhere.

# 1.2 Content strategy and planning

Random posting gets random results; strategy gets consistent growth. Start with clear goals (awareness, engagement, leads, sales) and a clear audience. Then define content 'pillars', a few recurring themes you'll be known for, so your feed has identity and you always know what to post. Planning ahead turns social media from stressful scrambling into a calm system.

Use a content calendar to plan posts in advance, balancing types (educational, entertaining, promotional, behind-the-scenes) so you're not always selling. Consistency is more important than perfection or frequency, a sustainable, regular rhythm builds an audience over time. A strategy on paper is what separates professional social media marketing from aimless posting.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *content strategy and planning* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real community growth calendar. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that strategy beats random posting., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 02 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A boutique defined three content pillars, new arrivals, styling tips, and customer features, and planned a month ahead. Posting became easy and consistent, the page gained a clear identity, and followers (and sales) grew steadily.

## How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Social Media Marketing workbook.

### HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 02

Your Practical Task: Define goals, audience, and three content pillars for a business. Plan one week of posts across those pillars in a simple calendar.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

## Module 02 Key Takeaways

**01**

Strategy beats random posting.

**02**

Define content pillars for identity and easy planning.

**03**

Consistency matters more than frequency.



# 02
# Core Frameworks & Strategy

Module 03: Creating engaging content | Module 04: Instagram and Facebook marketing

MODULE 03 · PART 1

# 2.1 Creating engaging content

Engaging content stops the scroll and makes people feel or act. The essentials: a strong hook (first line or first second), genuine value or entertainment, and a clear reason to engage (a question, a call to action). Visuals must be clean and eye-catching; video, especially short-form, currently gets the most reach on most platforms. Quality and relevance beat volume.

Know what your specific audience responds to and give them more of it. Mix formats (images, carousels, reels, stories, lives) to stay fresh, and always focus on the viewer, not just the brand, people engage with content that's about them, their problems and their aspirations. Authentic, useful, well-made content is what earns attention and grows a following.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *creating engaging content* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real community growth calendar. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that hook, value, and a clear reason to engage., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 03: CREATING ENGAGING CONTENT

COMMON BEGINNER MISTAKE

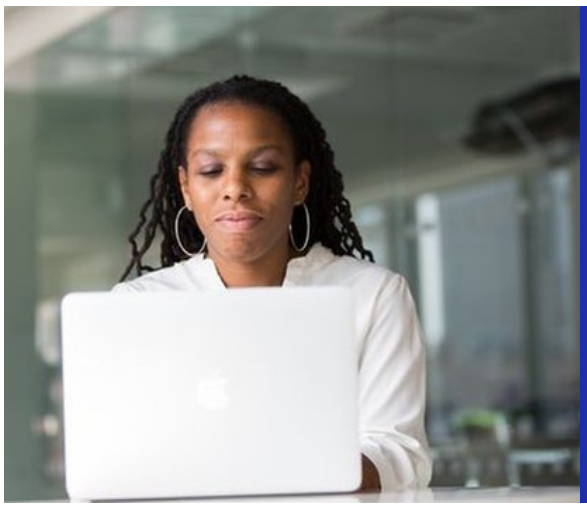
Rushing without structure, copying surface trends blindly, and skipping hands-on testing before moving to the next topic.

Outcome: Fragile community growth calendar that stalls under real conditions.

PRACTITIONER STANDARD

Hook, value, and a clear reason to engage. Paired with short video gets the most reach now.

Outcome: Reliable community growth calendar ready for real clients & growth.



MODULE 03 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A fitness coach's plain workout photos got little traction until she switched to short, energetic videos with a strong first line and a clear tip. Reach and engagement jumped, the format and hook made the same knowledge finally spread.

## How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Social Media Marketing workbook.

### HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 03

Your Practical Task: Create one piece of engaging content for a business: a strong hook, real value, clean visuals, and a call to engage. Post it and watch the response.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

## Module 03 Key Takeaways

**01**

Hook, value, and a clear reason to engage.

**02**

Short video gets the most reach now.

**03**

Make content about the viewer, not just the brand.

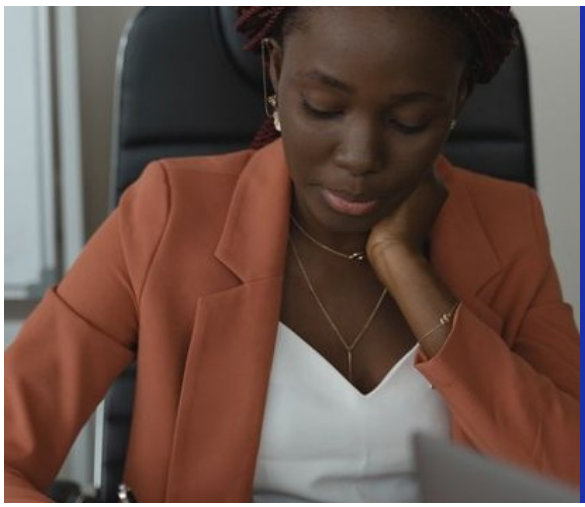
# 2.2 Instagram and Facebook marketing

Instagram is visual-first: use high-quality images and reels, a clear bio with a call to action, stories for daily connection, and relevant hashtags to be discovered. Consistency and a cohesive look build a strong brand presence. Reels are especially powerful for reaching new audiences beyond your current followers.

Facebook offers broad reach and powerful communities. Business pages, active participation in relevant Groups, and its events and marketplace features all help. Facebook and Instagram share an ad system (Meta Ads) with excellent targeting. For many local and consumer businesses, a strong presence across these two platforms covers most of their audience effectively.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *instagram and facebook marketing* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real community growth calendar. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that instagram: visuals, reels, stories, hashtags., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 04 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A local baker grew through Instagram reels of cakes being decorated (reaching new people) plus an active Facebook page and local group posts (reaching her community). Together they filled her order book without a shilling of ad spend at first.

## How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Social Media Marketing workbook.

### HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 04

Your Practical Task: Optimise an Instagram or Facebook business profile: clear bio, call to action, and a plan for one reel and one community/group post.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

## Module 04 Key Takeaways

01

Instagram: visuals, reels, stories, hashtags.

02

Facebook: pages, groups, events, broad reach.

03

They share a powerful ad system (Meta Ads).



# 03
# Execution & Applied Mastery

Module 05: TikTok and YouTube basics | Module 06: Analytics and insights

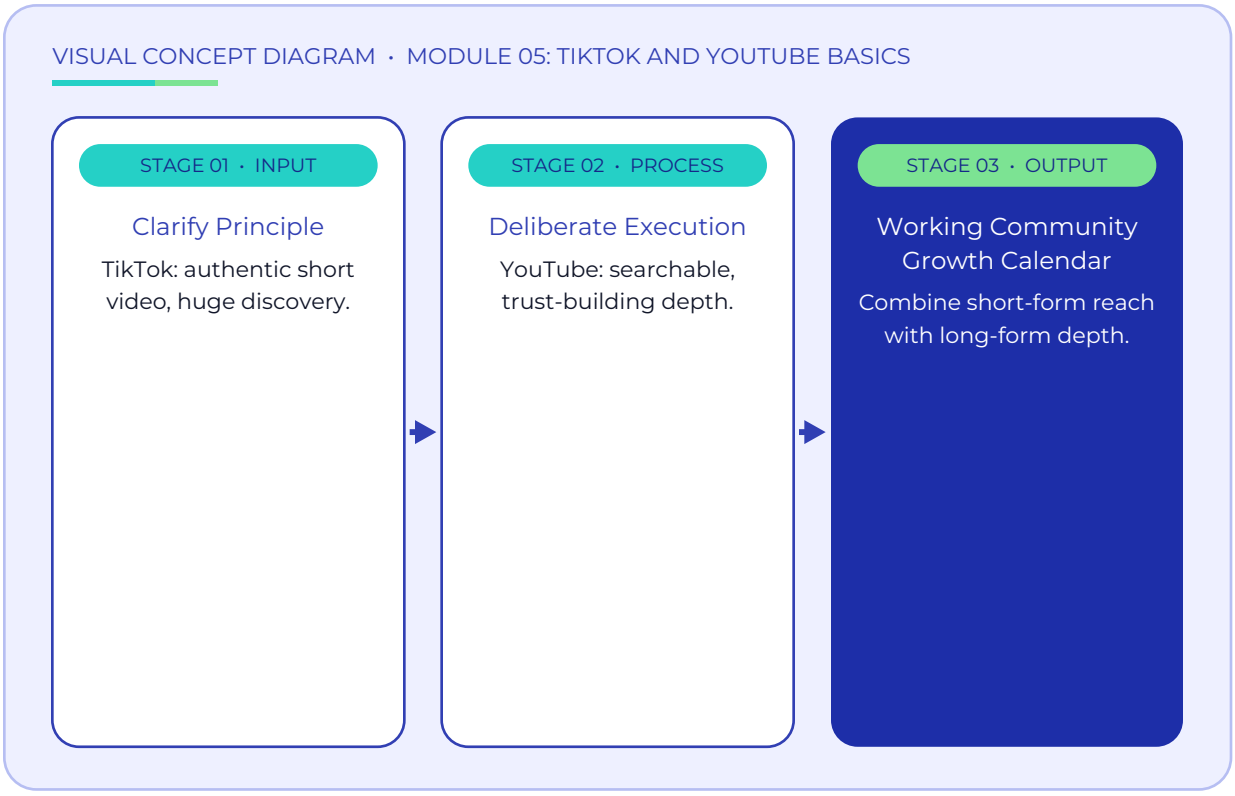
MODULE 05 · PART 1

# 3.1 TikTok and YouTube basics

TikTok rewards authentic, entertaining short videos and can give even small accounts huge reach through its powerful discovery algorithm. The keys: a scroll-stopping first second, trends and sounds, genuine (not overly polished) energy, and consistency. It's a remarkable free opportunity for brands and creators to reach new audiences fast.

YouTube is both a video platform and a search engine, ideal for longer, valuable content that people find via search for years. It builds deep trust and authority. Short-form (TikTok, Reels, Shorts) is best for fast reach and discovery; long-form (YouTube) is best for depth, trust and lasting searchable content. Used together, they cover both discovery and depth.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *tiktok and youtube basics* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real community growth calendar. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that tiktok: authentic short video, huge discovery., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.





MODULE 05 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A skincare brand posted quick TikToks that went semi-viral (reach) and detailed YouTube tutorials that ranked in search (trust and lasting traffic). New audiences discovered them on TikTok, then deepened trust on YouTube, and bought.

## How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Social Media Marketing workbook.

### HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 05

Your Practical Task: Plan one short-form video (hook + trend/value) for TikTok/Reels and one longer YouTube video idea (searchable, in-depth) for a business.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

## Module 05 Key Takeaways

**01**

TikTok: authentic short video, huge discovery.

**02**

YouTube: searchable, trust-building depth.

**03**

Combine short-form reach with long-form depth.

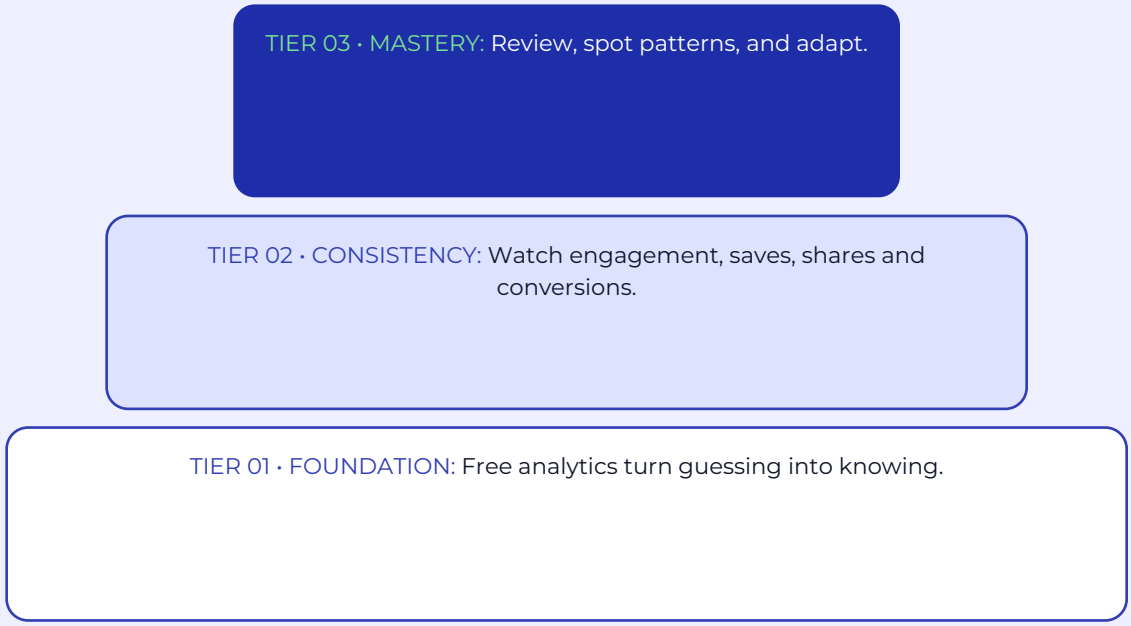
# 3.2 Analytics and insights

Every platform gives you free analytics, use them. They reveal what's working: which posts get reach, saves, shares and engagement; when your audience is online; and who your followers actually are. This data turns guesswork into informed decisions, letting you double down on what resonates and drop what doesn't.

Look beyond vanity metrics (raw likes and follower counts) to what matters for the goal: engagement rate, saves and shares (signals of real value), profile clicks, and conversions (leads or sales). Review regularly, spot patterns, and adjust your strategy. The marketer who reads insights and adapts consistently outperforms the one who just keeps posting on instinct.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *analytics and insights* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real community growth calendar. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that free analytics turn guessing into knowing., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 06: ANALYTICS AND INSIGHTS





MODULE 06 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A brand's analytics showed that its 'how-to' posts got far more saves and shares than its product posts. It made more how-to content, reach grew, and sales followed, the data revealed what the audience truly valued.

## How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Social Media Marketing workbook.

### HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 06

Your Practical Task: Open the analytics of any social account. Identify the top three posts by saves/shares/engagement and note what they have in common.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

## Module 06 Key Takeaways

01

Free analytics turn guessing into knowing.

02

Watch engagement, saves, shares and conversions.

03

Review, spot patterns, and adapt.



# 04
# Scaling, Capstone & Excellence

Module 07: Paid advertising basics | Module 08: Run a social media campaign

MODULE 07 · PART 1

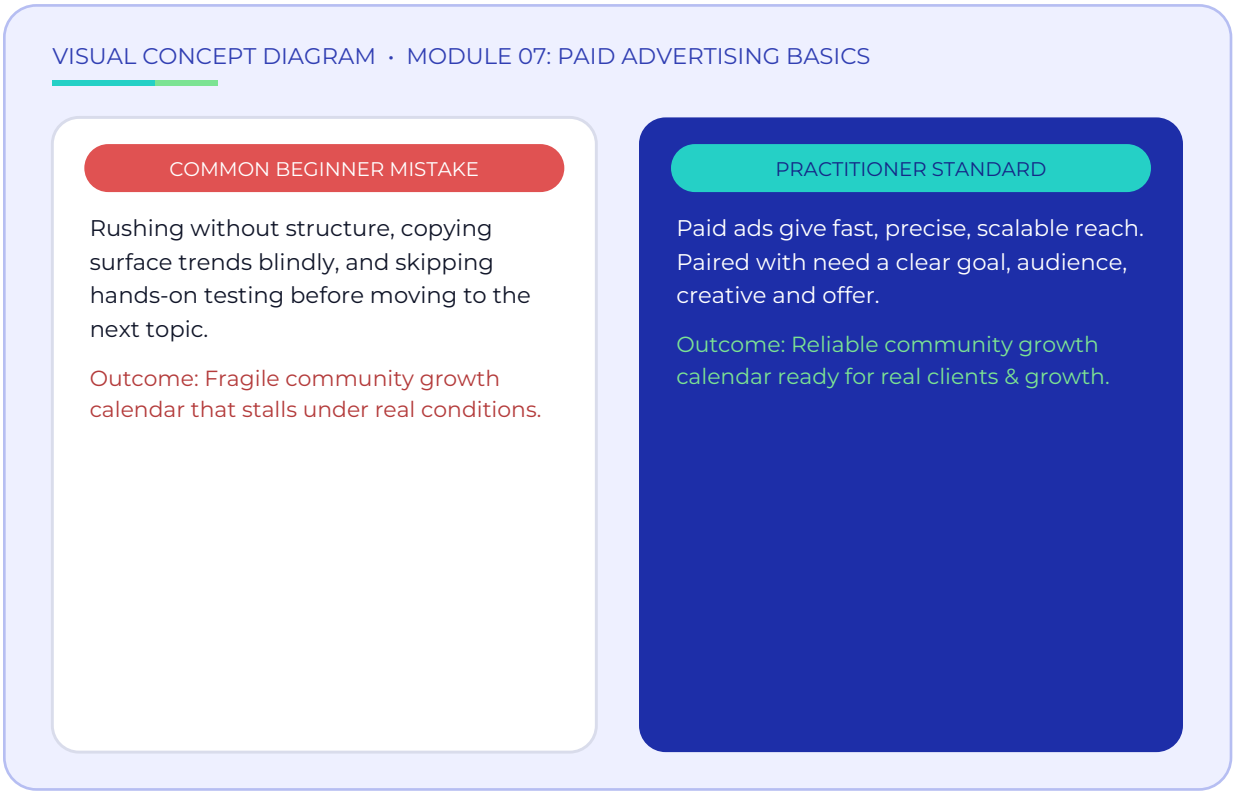
# 4.1 Paid advertising basics

Organic (free) reach is powerful but slow and increasingly limited; paid ads let you reach the right people quickly and at scale. Social ad platforms (especially Meta Ads for Facebook/Instagram) offer precise targeting by location, age, interests and behaviour, so even a small budget can reach exactly the right audience, far more efficiently than traditional advertising.

The basics of a good ad: a clear objective (reach, leads, or sales), a specific target audience, a strong creative (scroll-stopping visual and message), and a compelling offer. Start with a small budget, test different versions, and scale what works while cutting what doesn't. Skilled paid social is a highly valuable, in-demand service you can offer clients.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *paid advertising basics* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real community growth calendar. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that paid ads give fast, precise, scalable reach., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 07: PAID ADVERTISING BASICS





MODULE 07 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A small online shop spent a modest daily budget on a Meta ad targeting nearby shoppers interested in its niche, using a short video and a discount offer. It brought a clear, trackable return, more sales than the ad cost, and she scaled it up.

## How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Social Media Marketing workbook.

### HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 07

Your Practical Task: Design one paid ad plan: objective, exact target audience, creative concept, offer, and a small starting budget. Note how you'd measure success.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

## Module 07 Key Takeaways

**01**

Paid ads give fast, precise, scalable reach.

**02**

Need a clear goal, audience, creative and offer.

**03**

Start small, test, and scale winners.

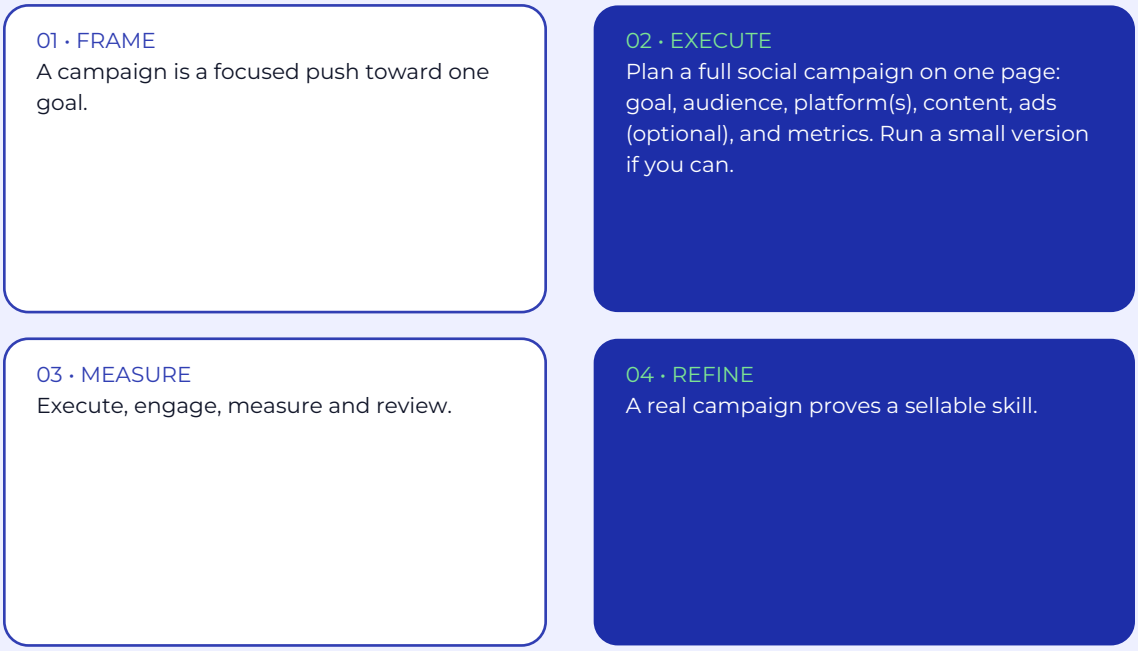
# 4.2 Run a social media campaign

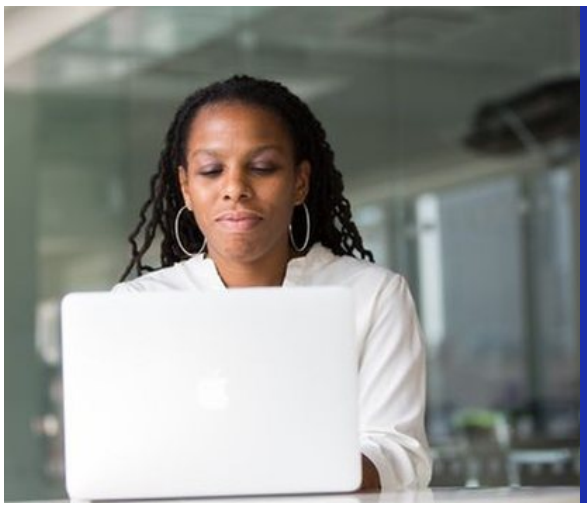
Your final project brings everything together: plan and run a real social media campaign for a business. Set the goal and audience, choose the platform(s), plan the content, decide whether to include paid ads, and define how you'll measure success. A campaign is a focused, coordinated effort over a set period toward one clear objective, not just ongoing posting.

Execute it, engage with the audience it attracts, track the results, and review what worked. Even a small real campaign teaches more than any theory and gives you a concrete result to show clients or employers. Social media marketing is a career-long learning field, keep creating, measuring and adapting, and your skills (and value) keep growing.

Why This Principle Matters in Depth: Many learners read about *run a social media campaign* at a surface level, yet struggle when building a real community growth calendar. Notice the underlying logic: when you anchor your work around the rule that a campaign is a focused push toward one goal., you remove guesswork and build repeatable confidence. Take time to study the visual concept diagram below before moving to the worked case study on the next page.

VISUAL CONCEPT DIAGRAM · MODULE 08: RUN A SOCIAL MEDIA CAMPAIGN





MODULE 08 · WORKED CASE STUDY

Real-World Scenario:
A learner ran a two-week launch campaign for a friend's new product: a content plan, a few reels, engagement replies, and a small ad. Tracked with a discount code, it drove real sales, proof of a genuine, sellable skill.

## How to Apply This Lesson Step by Step

Look closely at why the example above succeeded: instead of waiting for perfect conditions, the practitioner focused on one concrete deliverable and tested it in the real world. Use the guided assignment below to build the exact same muscle in your own Social Media Marketing workbook.

### HANDS-ON LAB ASSIGNMENT · MODULE 08

Your Practical Task: Plan a full social campaign on one page: goal, audience, platform(s), content, ads (optional), and metrics. Run a small version if you can.

Self-Check Before Moving On: Write down what worked, what felt unclear, and one specific improvement you will make on your second repetition. Competence comes from completed reps, never passive reading.

## Module 08 Key Takeaways

01

A campaign is a focused push toward one goal.

02

Execute, engage, measure and review.

03

A real campaign proves a sellable skill.

# 5.1 Complete 8-Module Practice & Competency Matrix

Review every module in Social Media Marketing using the table below. Check off each module only after you have completed its hands-on assignment and verified your work against the core principle.

| Module | Focus Topic | Core Principle | Workbook Check |
|---|---|---|---|
| Module 01 | Social media platforms overview | Each platform has its own audience and style. | Completed [ ] |
| Module 02 | Content strategy and planning | Strategy beats random posting. | Completed [ ] |
| Module 03 | Creating engaging content | Hook, value, and a clear reason to engage. | Completed [ ] |
| Module 04 | Instagram and Facebook marketing | Instagram: visuals, reels, stories, hashtags. | Completed [ ] |
| Module 05 | TikTok and YouTube basics | TikTok: authentic short video, huge discovery. | Completed [ ] |
| Module 06 | Analytics and insights | Free analytics turn guessing into knowing. | Completed [ ] |
| Module 07 | Paid advertising basics | Paid ads give fast, precise, scalable reach. | Completed [ ] |
| Module 08 | Run a social media campaign | A campaign is a focused push toward one goal. | Completed [ ] |

### CAPSTONE PORTFOLIO STANDARD

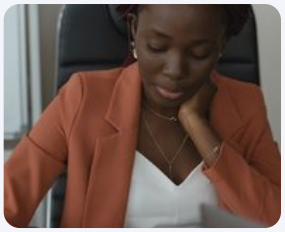
Before graduating from this handbook, combine all eight modules into one finished, shareable community growth calendar: *Plan a full social campaign on one page: goal, audience, platform(s), content, ads (optional), and metrics. Run a small version if you can.* When ready for mentor feedback, email your work to chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com.

# 5.2 Applied Fellowship Case Reflections

Real transformation happens when learners turn theory into consistent service. Reflect on these cohort case highlights from across East Africa as you prepare your own project:

*"A local restaurant wasted effort on LinkedIn before realising its customers were on Instagram and Facebook. Refocusing there, appetising photos and local community posts, finally brought real bookings. Right platform, right result."*

Cohort Case Reflection | Starting Strong in Module 01





*"A local baker grew through Instagram reels of cakes being decorated (reaching new people) plus an active Facebook page and local group posts (reaching her community). Together they filled her order book without a shilling of ad spend at first."*

Mid-Course Breakthrough | Applying Strategy in Module 04

*"A learner ran a two-week launch campaign for a friend's new product: a content plan, a few reels, engagement replies, and a small ad. Tracked with a discount code, it drove real sales, proof of a genuine, sellable skill."*

Capstone Completion | Shipping Real Work in Module 08



Stewardship Principle: "Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with excellence, integrity, and faithfulness so your skill becomes a blessing to many."

# 06 90-Day Action Roadmap

True mastery in Social Media Marketing is measured by what you build, ship, and steward after finishing the lessons. Follow this structured 90-day implementation plan developed by CHRISCO Youth Aflame (under CHRISCO Fellowship of Churches) to turn study into fruitfulness.

## 6.1 Four-Stage Post-Course Milestones

### 01

Days 1 to 14: Foundation Sprint

Complete Modules 1 to 4 labs and document your baseline specimen in Social Media Marketing.

### 02

Days 15 to 30: First Live Output

Complete Modules 5 to 8 and ship your first real capstone deliverable: Plan a full social campaign on one page: goal, audience, platform(s), content, ads (optional), and metrics. Run a small version if you can.

### 03

Days 31 to 60: Feedback & Iteration

Share your work with a mentor, peer, or real client/community audience and refine weak points.

### 04

Days 61 to 90: Service & Multiplication

Use your skill to serve your church, business, or clients faithfully and mentor one younger learner.

| Follow-Up Stage | CHRISCO Support Channel | Contact & Cadence |
|---|---|---|
| Workbook Review | CHRISCO Digital Academy Desk | chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com |
| Capstone Submission | CHRISCO Youth Aflame Mentors | shambetz@gmail.com |
| Peer Accountability | CHRISCO Fellowship Study Hubs | Monthly Cohort Check-In |

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# Equipping Youth, Elevating Purpose


CHRISCO Youth Aflame
CHRISCO Digital Academy
Under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES

Official Gmail Contacts
chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com
shambetz@gmail.com



Official 28-Page Illustrated Course E-Book for Social Media Marketing (Brand Community & Social Strategy Track).
Prepared by CHRISCO Youth Aflame under CHRISCO FELLOWSHIP OF CHURCHES.
For course guidance or mentorship, email chriscoyouthaflame2025@gmail.com. CHRISCO Youth Aflame